



1258 Siege of Baghdad

After a 13-day siege, the city of Baghdad surrendered to Mongol ruler Hulagu Khan and his army. Thousands were killed in the bloodshed that followed, and the Islamic Golden Age came to a devastating end.

Born this day

1879 Sarojini Naidu, Indian poet and activist. She was the first female president of the Indian National Congress.

1908 Pauline Frederick, US journalist. The first woman to be employed as a network news correspondent, she inspired other women to work in the media industry.

Also on this day

1945 During World War II, the UK and USA began three days of bombing raids on the city of Dresden, Germany. The resulting firestorm destroyed more than 6.5 sq km (2.5 sq miles) of the city centre.

2004 The largest known diamond in the Universe – a white dwarf star – was discovered by astronomers. They named it Lucy, after a song by The Beatles.

2008 Australian prime minister Kevin Rudd formally apologized to the First Australians for the suffering caused by previous governments.

February

13

1866

Daylight robbery

US outlaw Jesse James carried out his first bank robbery, stealing US \$15,000 from the Clay County Savings Association in Missouri, USA. This was one of the first bank robberies carried out in broad daylight.



1988

Bobsleigh heroes

With no history in winter sports and limited training, four Jamaicans competed in the four-person bobsleigh event at the Winter Olympics in Calgary, Canada. They finished last, but were celebrated as heroes for their sportsmanship and team spirit.

